



16 May 1966

CULTURAL REVOLUTION IN CHINA

After the failure of his “Great Leap Forward” initiative, China’s leader Mao Zedong moved to regain control by proclaiming a purge of revisionist elements and a return to hardline Communist doctrines as in the “little red book” of Maoist thought. Intellectuals and cultural artefacts were attacked, economic activity slowed, and hundreds of thousands of suspected opponents were killed by his youthful Red Guard supporters. Many significant ancient structures and customs were destroyed because traditional culture was seen as preventing a true Communist revolution.

◁ Chairman Mao’s backers show their support at a mass rally

24 November 1965 General Mobutu stages a coup that puts an end to five years of civil war in the former Belgian Congo

21 April 1967 A military junta seizes power in Greece, ending 23 years of democratic government

1967



◁ Rhodesia’s premier, Ian Smith

11 November 1965

RHODESIA PROCLAIMS UDI

Britain refused to hand power to its colony Rhodesia unless it introduced majority rule. The white-dominated government of the colony announced a Unilateral Declaration of Independence (UDI), declaring itself a sovereign state. Fifteen years of conflict followed before white rule ended and the state of Zimbabwe came into being in 1980.

▽ Israeli tanks moving into the Gaza Strip



5-10 June 1967

THE SIX DAY WAR

Following increased tensions between Israel and Egypt, the Israeli military launched pre-emptive strikes against Egyptian airfields. Israeli forces dominated the ensuing land battle against Egypt and its allies Jordan and Syria. By the time a ceasefire was declared it had won control of East Jerusalem, the Golan Heights, the Sinai Peninsula, and the Gaza Strip.